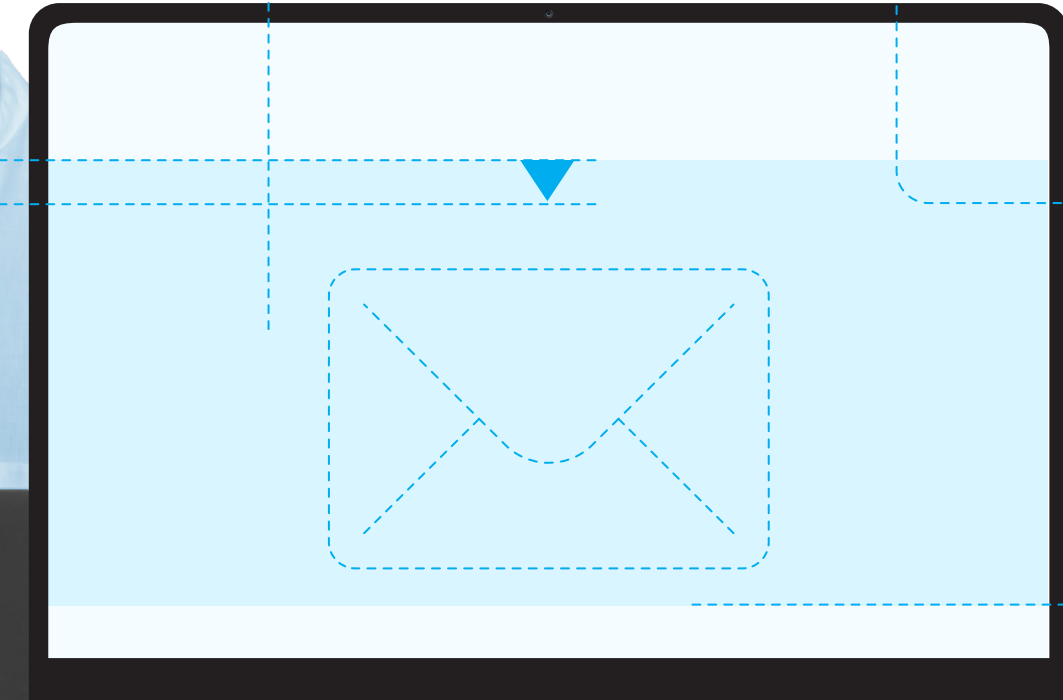
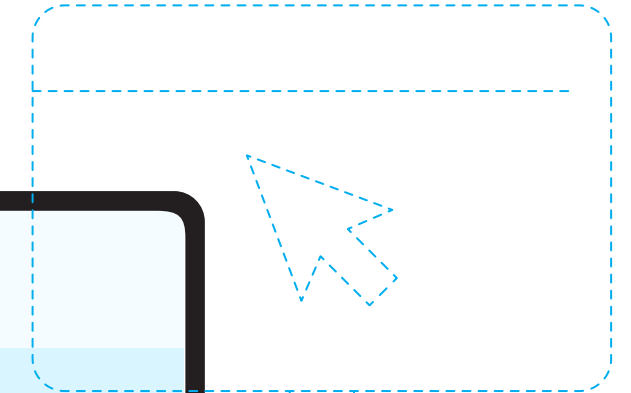
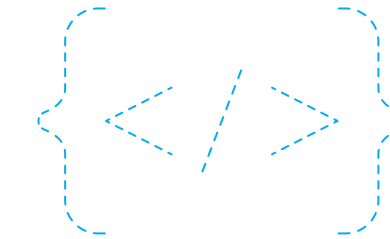
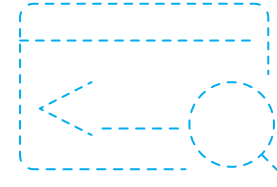
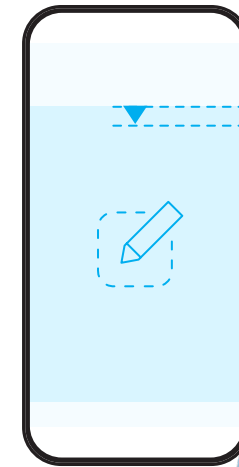


Revised November

2023

NCB Financial Group

Email Design Style Guide



NOTE: This Email Design guideline applies to NCB Financial Group Limited, NCB Jamaica Limited, NCB Capital Markets Limited, NCB Foundation, NCB Insurance Agency and Fund Managers Limited, NCB Merchant Bank Trinidad and Tobago Limited, NCB Capital Markets Barbados Limited, NCB Capital Markets Guyana Limited

NCB
FINANCIAL GROUP
LIMITED



Things to Explore

Let’s become familiar with what our email style guide entails.

Preparing Content

xx

- Brand voice and tone
- Personalisation
- Link blocker
- Link blocker attributes and values
- Email design

Brand Identity

xx

- Logo
- Colour palette
- Typography
- Icon
- Call-Out Point

Email Testing

xx

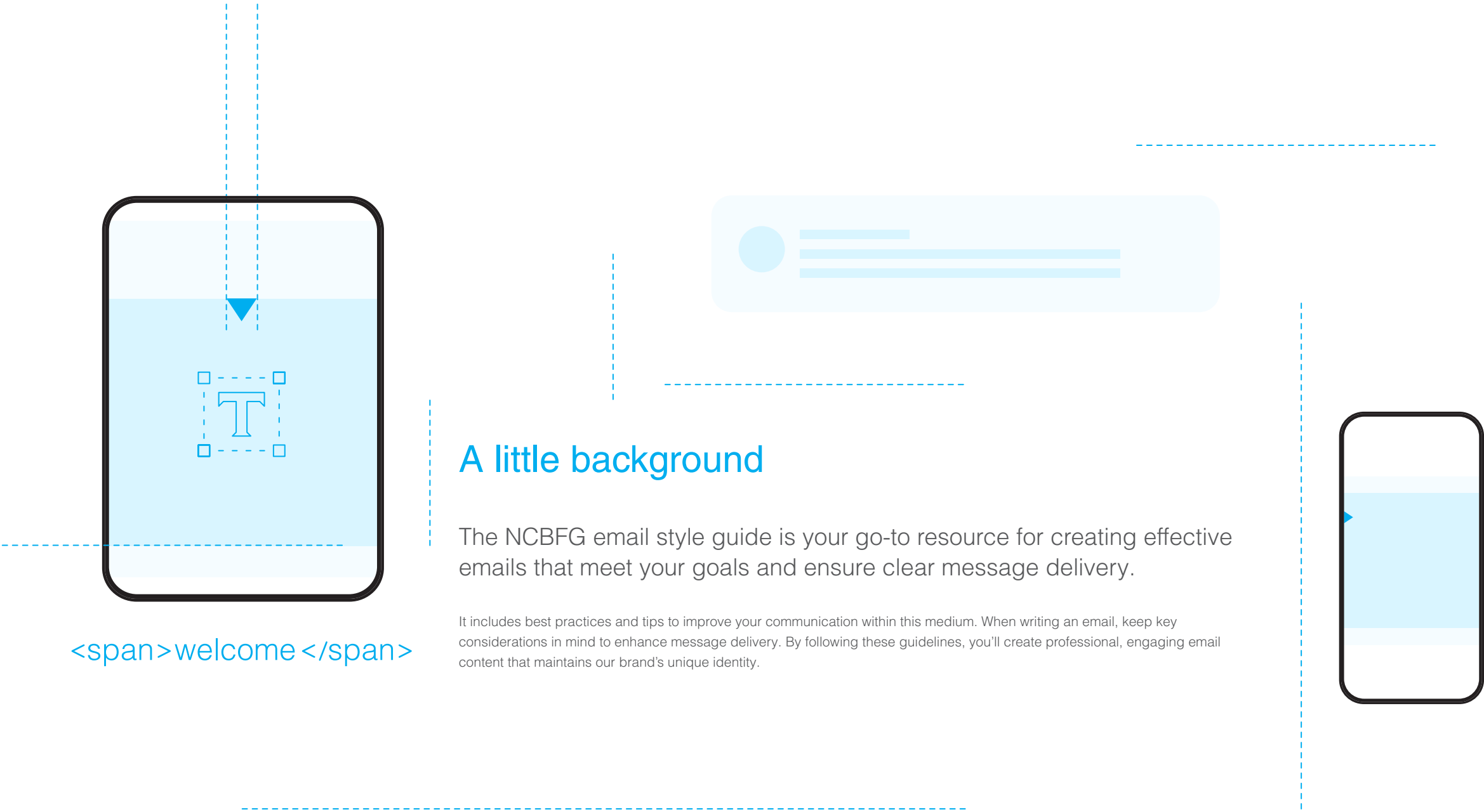
- Pre-development and email test stage and quality assurance

Assets Library

xx

Contact Information

xx



A little background

The NCBFG email style guide is your go-to resource for creating effective emails that meet your goals and ensure clear message delivery.

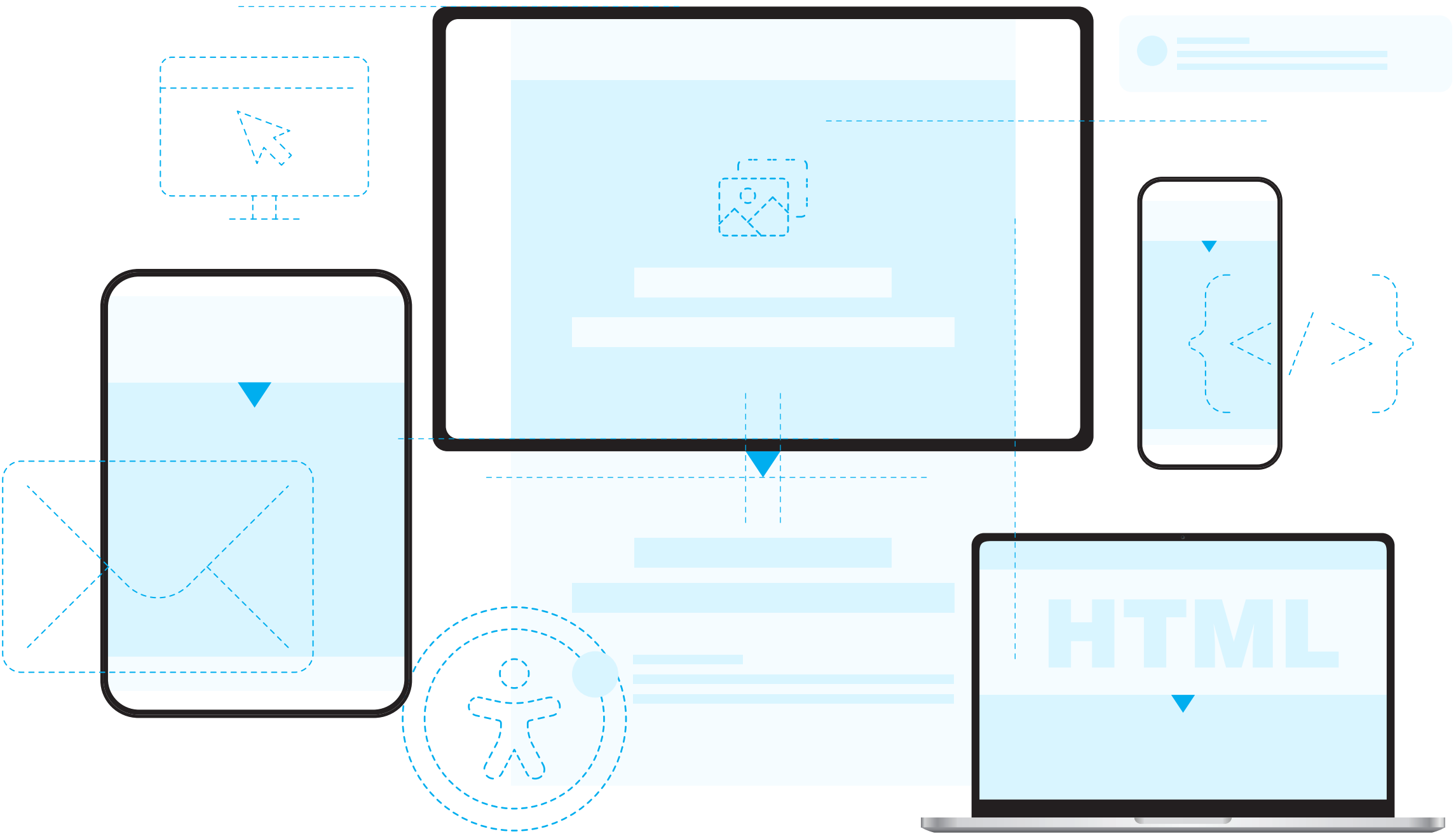
It includes best practices and tips to improve your communication within this medium. When writing an email, keep key considerations in mind to enhance message delivery. By following these guidelines, you'll create professional, engaging email content that maintains our brand's unique identity.

▶ Preparing Content

This section underscores the paramount importance of our brand’s tone, voice, personalisation and email design.

What to explore in this section:

- Brand voice and tone
- Personalisation
- Link blocker
- Link blocker attributes and values
- Email Design



Brand voice and tone

Our brand tone and voice in email communication plays a pivotal role in connecting with our audience. It's more than just exchanging messages; it's about customer experience and leaving a lasting impression while maintaining our brand's identity.

When writing an email, there are a few things to keep in mind to ensure that your message is communicated effectively.

Keep the message concise

- ▶ Determine the focus of your email and make that message as simple as possible for the reader. Information should also be meaningful to the customer. Essentially, you're creating the CliffsNotes version of your product.
- ▶ The body of your email should align with the subject line.
- ▶ Research shows that most persons spend 15seconds reading an email, so prioritize the information you want customers to takeaway in the first fold of your email.

Communicate your main message first

- ▶ You can also explore placing this information at the end of the email as well.
- ▶ Write in the second person using pronouns like "you", "yours" and "your" – this will allow the message to feel more personal. Keep the focus on the customer not the brand by using less "we" and "our" and "ours". Try to find a good balance between the two.
- ▶ Talk about benefits, not features – this a good rule of thumb for all communication. The value of the product to the customer should be clear after reading your email.
- ▶ Be brief – try and summarize your message in a compelling way so that even the skim reader can determine the value right away. If you know the action you want persons to take, then making your email succinct will be that much easier.
- ▶ Stick to one CTA – Having one main message that you are communicating makes it easier for the reader to follow and reduces likelihood of them getting confused. This will also help to keep your message to the point. If you have more than one message to communicate, consider sending multiple emails.

Here's an article that will help you to write more concisely: blog.hubspot.com/marketing/concise-writing-exercises.

Brand tone and voice

Voice and tone

Avoid the corporate mumbo jumbo. Good writing is about getting your audience to understand your offer and the benefits they will gain in the simplest way possible. Understand your audience and the message and determine the best tone and language to communicate with them. Here are some tips:

- ▶ Use an active voice - passive verb construction is a clear sign of over
- ▶ formalised language. Take out the extra words and put your subjects back up front.
- ▶ Use a conversational tone so the message feels more personal and avoid technical jargons – try asking questions to keep the reader engaged.

Communicate your main message first examples of active voice vs passive voice



Hi Hyacinth,

We'd like to hear your feedback on a new thing we've developed. Let us know if you'd be able to come in and test xx product on Saturday August 9. Let us know which time works best for you.

See you there!

▲ Active Voice



NCB would like for its customers to give feedback on xx product. If you are available to test, please send an email to test@jncb.com.

▲ Passive Voice

Personalisation

Personalised emails have the capacity to grab the recipient’s attention by tailoring messages to match their interests, preferences, and behaviors. This, in turn, results in content that is more relevant and engaging, significantly heightening the likelihood of generating a positive response.



Layout information clearly

- ▶ Keep paragraphs short, use headings and bulleted lists to separate content into sections. This will make the information easy to understand and easy to skim and scan.
- ▶ 5Ws and Hs – included in your first paragraph.
- ▶ Make your design more approachable by using sufficient “white space” to give your content some breathing room.



Personalize your email and call to action (CTA)

- ▶ Replace generic CTA with one that more direct and personal to your message. Eg replace “learn more” with “Get me a car now”.
- ▶ Try sticking to one CTA so it is clear to the customer what action you want them to take after reading your message.



Compress your files:

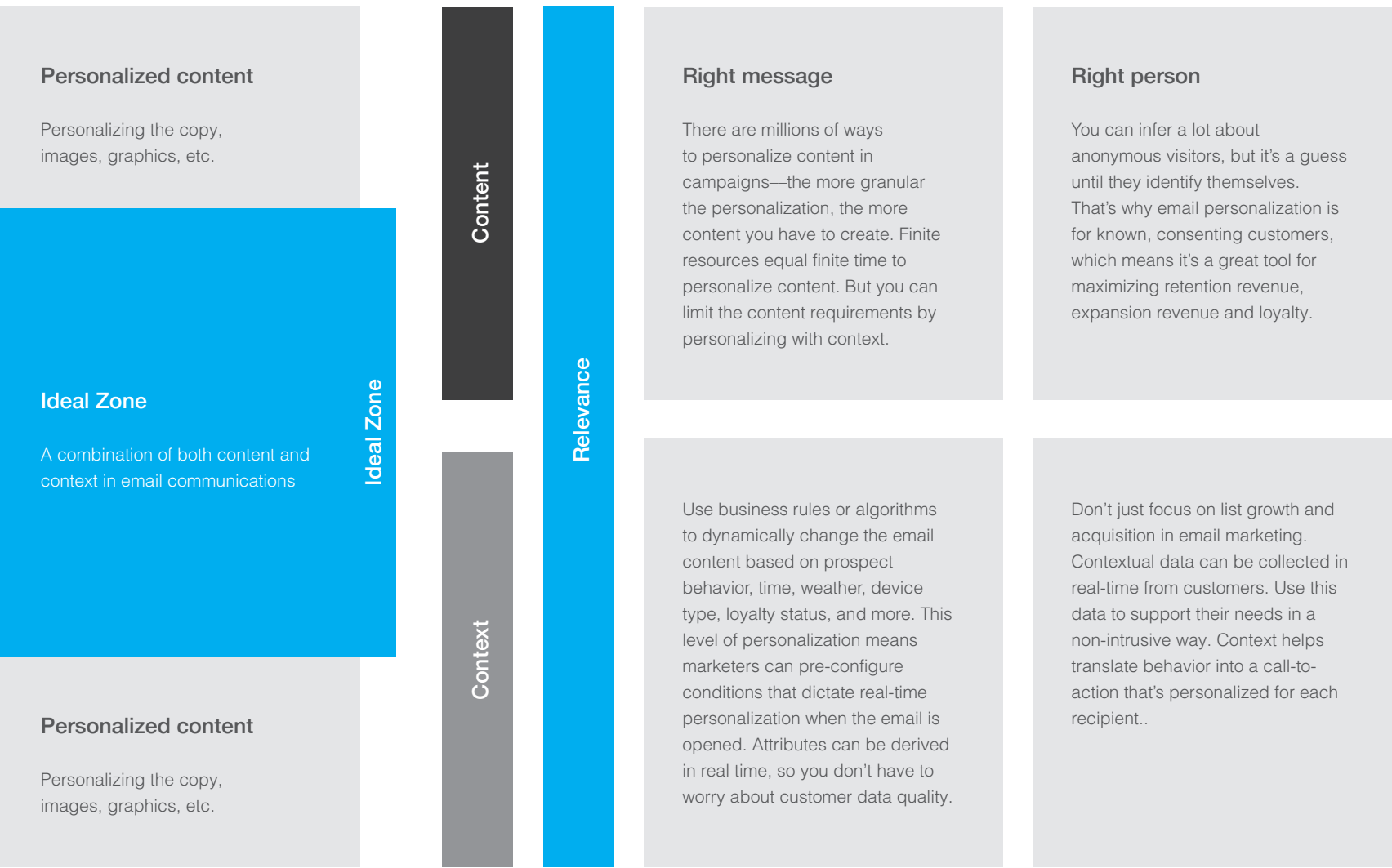
This a great way to retain quality of the image while reducing file size; www.tinypng.com provides a great compression tool for .png and .jpeg images



Alt Text

- Alt text is the text that is displayed in the event the images in your email do not load or has been blocked to provide context to your mail. It also makes your email readable by the visually impaired. When writing alt text, you simply want to describe its image as accurately and concisely as you can in one or two sentences.
- ▶ Alt text should be short to promote longer reading (125 characters or less, including space)
 - ▶ Punctuate the message as you would if it were written as plain text
 - ▶ Avoid quotation marks as they will affect your HTML code
 - ▶ Don't copy the image's caption. Alt text should contain the caption's information and more.
 - ▶ Purely decorative or utilitarian images should have an empty alt attribute (alt = "") to inform screen readers that the image should be ignored.

Personalisation



Personalisation

Image-to-text ratio

The guiding principle is to use 80:20 text to image ratio in emails. Just so we're clear its 80% text and 20% images. This is important to maintain for a number of reasons:

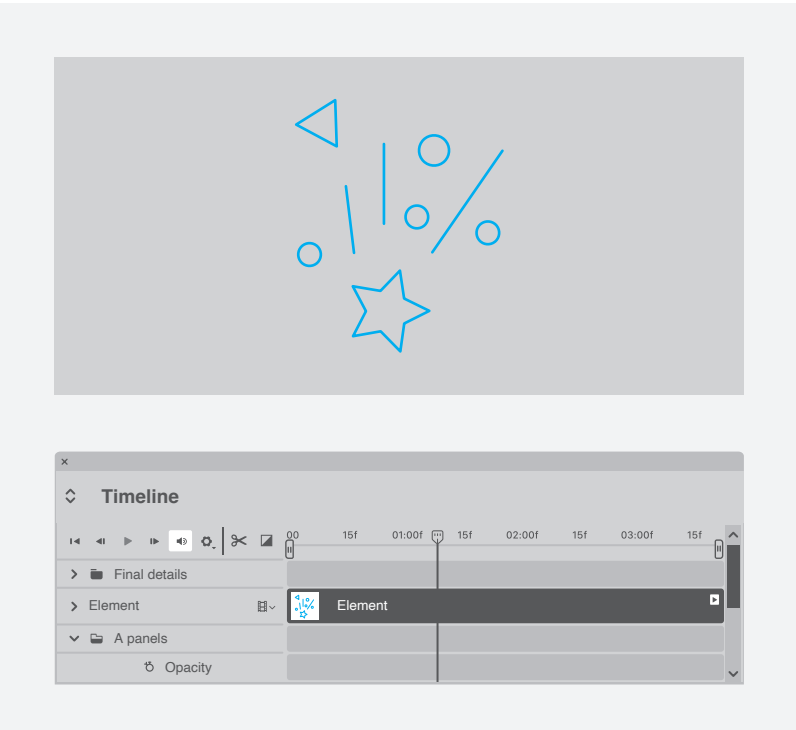
- ▶ All image emails usually end up in spam folders. You didn't work so hard on your email to have no one read it.
- ▶ Some users turn off images – this means that the images will be blocked. If 80% of your email is text, then the reader can still understand your email with no problems.
- ▶ Images take more time to load – we live in a data conscious world and no reader wants to use up all their data to read a company email.
- ▶ Spam Assassin, a popular spam blocker uses the following guidelines:
- ▶ A maximum of 40% image coverage
- ▶ A minimum 60% text coverage
- ▶ No more than 3 images in the page – if any at all.
- ▶ Not all images touching.
- ▶ At least 400 characters of text.

Plain text

Always create a plain text version of your emails. Some readers don't like fancy designs and will prefer the plain text version of your email instead. Plain text also helps to avoid the spam folder.

Video and animation

Using videos in emails is a great way to build engagement and increase open rates. However most email clients don't allow autoplay of videos. Using HTML 5 is a good option for videos as it is more widely supported. Since we can't send links, GIFs are a great alternative to videos.



- ▲ Using GIFs is a great way to add character to your email. Animations seen in emails are normally GIF format.

Personalisation

Here are some key points to note when using GIFs in emails:

- 

Only animate what you need – the more animation the longer the loading time which means less time for persons to view your email. Remember, we only have 15 seconds to grab our readers attention.
- 

Keep it small – larger images have larger file sizes. Try cropping the image as much as possible. GIF size should be 500KB or less.
- 

Minimize the number of colours – more colours increase file size. Choose wisely what elements you animate.
- 

Keep it short – try and keep the number of frames in the animation to a minimum (less than 10).
- 

Place the most important information on the first frame – as some internet clients only show the first frame.
- 

Always loop your animation – give customers a chance to see the full message if you grabbed their attention in the middle of the GIF frames.
- 

Only animate part of the picture. Don't force the entire image to redraw itself in every frame. Use layers in Photoshop to isolate animated parts and only animate those layers.
- 

GIFs should last no more than 5seconds – calculate gif length using the following equation: number of frames x frame rate x number of repetitions
- 

Use them sparingly – overuse of GIFs might reduce engagement

Deactivating links

We have deactivated links in our emails by utilizing HTML attributes and entities. In order to maintain non-clickable URLs when composing content in HTML, we kindly request your adherence to the following guidelines.

Decrypting links

Using an inline CSS tag (span) and letter spacing with a negative value (letter-space: -value) and none break space () HTML tags. For example:

Status	HTML Backend	Browser Preview
A.I. detection without entity	www.jncb.com	www.jncb.com
A.I. detection with entity	w w w . j n c b . c o m	www.jncb.com

WORD joiner

Word-Joiner (⁠) W3C recommends using the Word-Joiner whenever you need to connect two characters or words so that they do not wrap. For example:

Status	HTML Backend	Browser Preview
OFF	Call us today at 888-NCB-FIRST&(622-3477)	Call us today at 888-NCB-FIRST (622-3477)
ON	Call us today at 888-NCB-⁠FIRST&(622-3477)	Call us today at 888-NCB-FIRST 622-3477)

Deactivating links attributes and values

Name	Font Size	Value
Headline	@ 30px	-3.5 px
Sub-Headline	@ 20px	-2.4 px
Body	@ 15px	-2px
Caption	@ 12px	-1.5px

Adjustment Values

We have predetermined values to maintain consistency across all our emails.

Link preview

Name	Description
www.jncb.com	Properly: URL has a letter-spacing attribute with correct value and non-breaking space. w w w . j n c b . c o m
w w w . j n c b . c o m	Improperly: URL has a letter-spacing attribute with incorrect value or has non-breaking space with no value.-2.4 px Scenario 1 w w w . j n c b . c o m Scenario 2 w w w . j n c b . c o m
wwwjncb.com	Improperly: URL has a letter-spacing attribute with incorrect value or has no non-breaking space.-2px Scenario 1 w w w . j n c b . c o m Scenario 2 www.jncb.com

Alternate ways to deactivate links

You can enhance clickable hyperlink security by employing the mothereff HTML entity encoder/decoder. Follow these steps: Visit <https://mothereff.in/html-entities>. Copy your hyperlink and paste it into the decoded input box. To reveal the result, uncheck the "only encode unsafe and non-ASCII characters" option. Insert the entity definition ""‍" between each character in the encoded input box. Copy the encoded text and incorporate it into your HTML code.

Email design

Email providers may display emails with variations in width and height. To ensure that your email is correctly and consistently rendered across all email providers and web browsers, it's advisable to maintain an email width within the range of 600-640 px.



Email layout

Email providers may display emails with variations in width and height. To ensure that your email is correctly and consistently rendered across all email providers and web browsers, it's advisable to maintain an email width within the range of 600-640 px.

Remember, that overuse of CAPS and unnecessary punctuation, as well as some words, can trigger spam filters so respect your subscribers and don't go there. The first fold where your most important information should be is usually between 300–500 px high.

Body

To bring vitality to your email content, it's essential to include a blend of text, images, and icons within the email body. However, Never incorporate clickable hyperlinks or QR codes directly in the email. For guidance on how to disable clickable hyperlinks, please refer to page xx.

Email design

Header section

Generally, a logo that is placed in the header is to be used in its full colour representation, unless a special case is required and the necessary approval is secured.

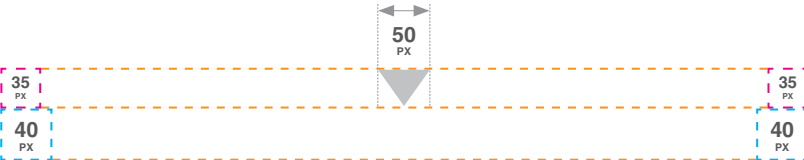
When using our Full colour logo always use on background colour: White (#ffffff). In special logo use case, the white version of our logo should be used on background colour: (#005baa). The NCBFG logo and its subsidiaries must maintain 35 px high.



Header specification: 600x70 px

Call-Out Point attention identity

NCB's current advertising strategy employs the use of 'Call-Out Points' to highlight key elements within the layout, such as headlines, images, and important text. This enhances the effectiveness of message delivery. For uniformity, we have established a fixed size for it: 50x35 px with proportional constraints.



Call-Out Point specification: 50x35 px

Hero

Images in your email require proper sizing in order to avoid stretching and squishing. The larger the file, the longer it will take for your email to load which can lead to reduced effectiveness. Your email file size should not exceed 1MB. Images should not exceed 600-640 px (in keeping with email widths). In order to maintain high resolution display, images should be 2x (1200px) the size and image attributes and CSS used to maintain the correct width.



Hero spec: MIN: 600x640 px, MIN: 600x800 px, MAX: File size 1 MB

Email design

Icon creation and distribution properties

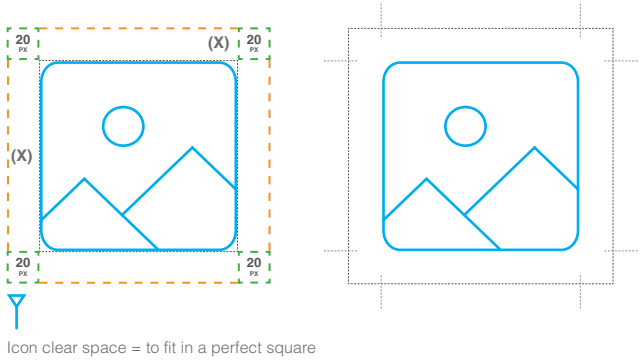
To preserve and maintain a clever brand presence, use the following setting. Make your artboard 70x70 px. Set your stroke weight to 3 pt then start drawing your stroked icon to represent the appropriate context.

Icon stroke settings

In the icon panel of your design program ensure that cap is set to round cap; corner: round join; align stroke: align stroke to centre and stroke weight for screen: 3 pt.

Icon clear space

Leave clear space for icons to ensure the surrounding area is visually uncluttered and has room to breathe and stand out. By providing separation from surrounding elements, clear space allows each design component to shine and communicate effectively with the audience.



Responsive design

Design emails with consideration for various screen sizes. Responsive design ensures compatibility across a wide range of devices and screen dimensions. Meticulously test for responsiveness to ensure a seamless and user-friendly experience.

Common breakpoints

There are a multitude of screens and devices, each with varying heights and widths, making it challenging to establish precise breakpoints for each individual device. To simplify matters, we have placed focus on targeting four common groups:

			
0-480	481-768	769-1279	1280+
Smaller smartphones	Tablets and larger smartphones	Laptops, small desktops and larger tablets in landscape	Large desktops and monitors

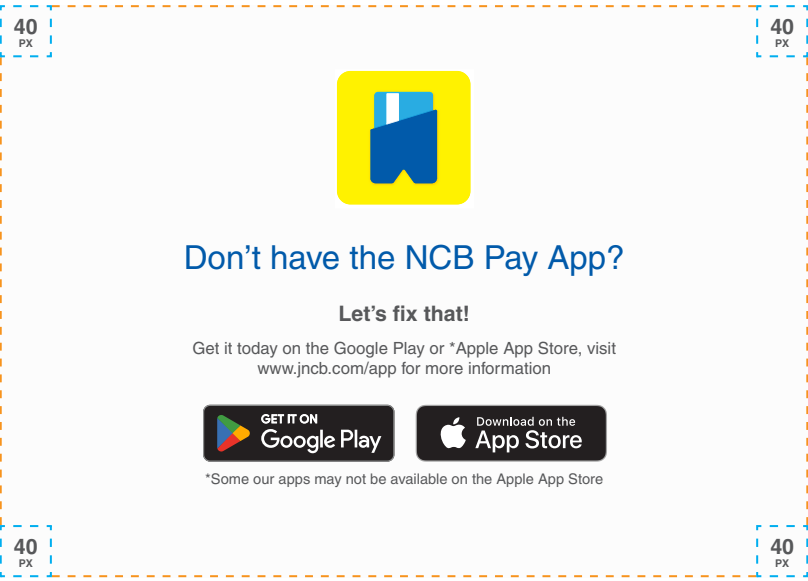
Photography and illustrations

Using images to spice up your email campaign can be a great idea as they grab a lot of attention. Use high-quality, on-brand images and illustrations or GIFs in your emails; they should complement the overall design. Your email should still make sense to the reader even when the images are removed. Ensure images are optimized for email and have proper alt text for accessibility.

Email design

Promotional band

The Promotional band is a personalised ad positioned just above the email footer and should be featured in all marketing or promotional emails. The ad should be customised to meet the need of push based on the campaign. Please refrain from including this footer in advisory messages, notifications, or other emails categorized as critical communications.



▲ The promotional band encourages app downloads.

Sign off

This is the concluding section of our email, which typically features a polite and professional statement or phrase: “Stay safe - from team NCB”, “National Commercial Bank Jamaica Limited”, “Empower People, Unlocking Dreams, Buidling Communitess”. The content of the closing may vary depending on the subject matter, products, or business context.

Standard footer

The footer of emails are standard across all brands and subsidiary. In this cases the footer assumes a background of hex values (#xxxxxx) font size: 12px, and font colour white (#xxxxxx).

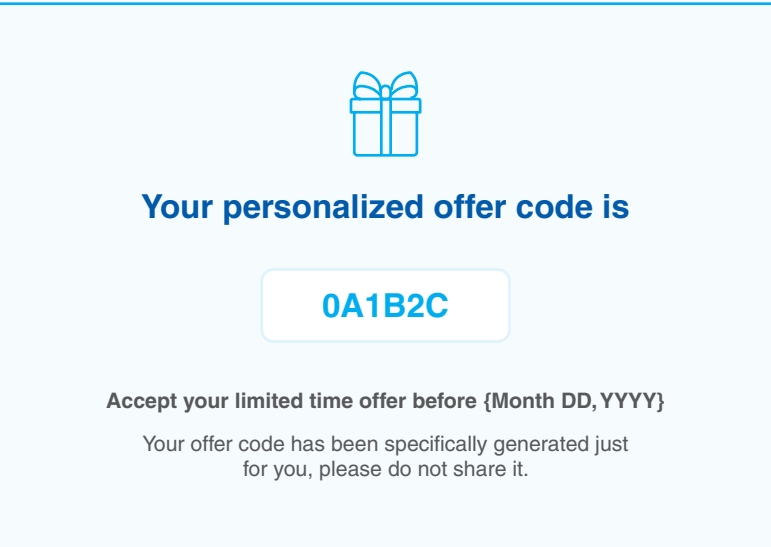


▲ Standard footer

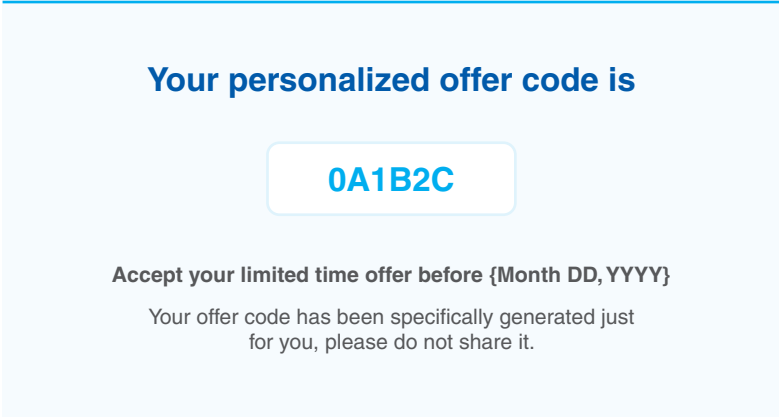
Email design

Offer Code

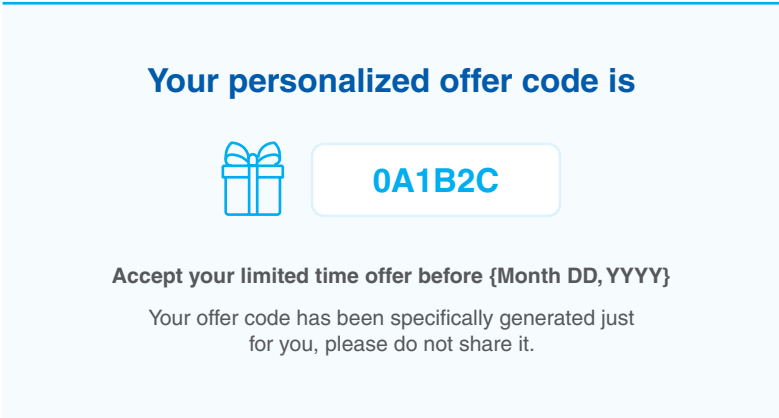
At times, certain emails within our campaigns may feature an offer code. This is a concise presentation of a promotional code specifically extended to our selected customers. To ensure visual consistency, we have thoughtfully integrated this element into our design structure to align with the email's subject matter. We kindly request strict adherence to these guidelines.



▲ Offer code with icon and text expanded



▲ Offer code with icon and text only

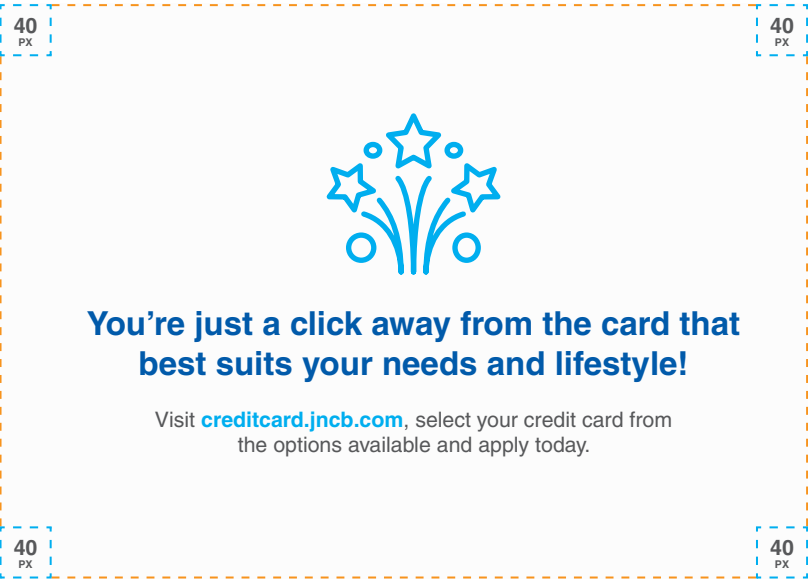


▲ Offer code with icon and text compact

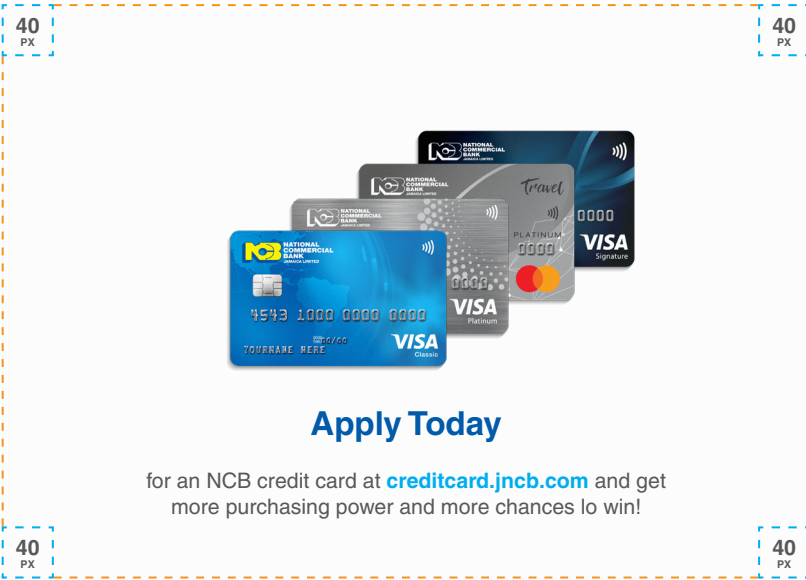
Email design

Call to action (CTA)

Our current language does not employ clickable links. Therefore, it's crucial to design clear and eye-catching CTAs that prominently feature in the email. Make sure that these CTAs align with our brand colors and adhere to our style.



▲ Icon style CTA



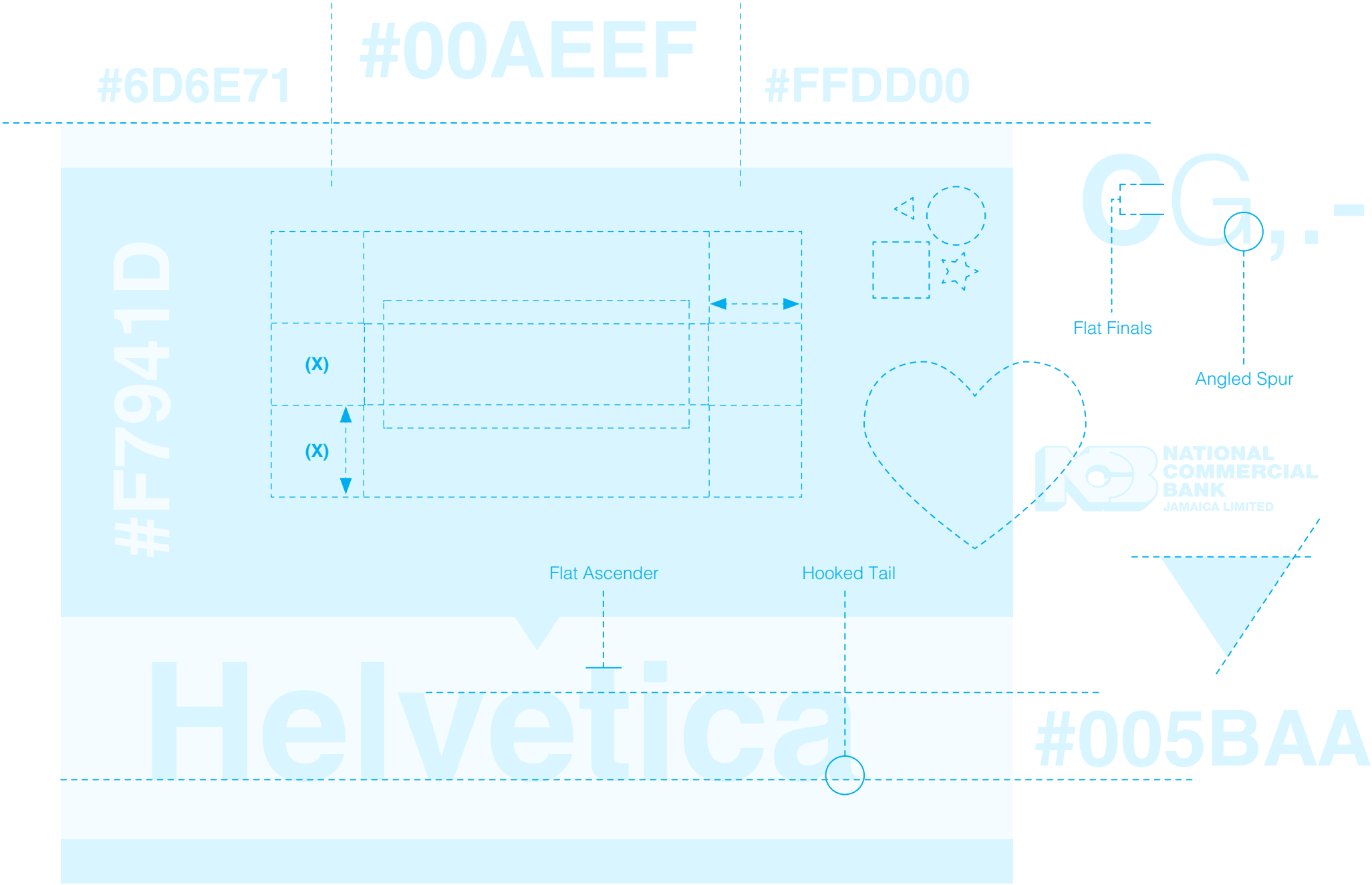
▲ Image style CTA

► Brand Identity

Our brand identity captures the core principles for achieving a harmonized design structure, specifically focusing on the most frequently utilised use case.

What to explore in this section:

- Logo
- Colour Palette
- Typography
- Icon
- Call-Out Point



NCB logo lockup

Our logo is an essential identifier of our brand. Therefore, to ensure that it is always legible and appropriately represented, specific guidelines have been established to govern its use.



Ncb icon + NCB logotype = NCB signature

This NCB signature system is the graphic representation of our company and the value for which it stands. It identifies us to all stakeholders, displaying an image that is both strong and discrete. The NCB signature combines the two most important visual elements of our brand, the NCB logotype and the NCB symbol. The diagram to the left illustrates the recognizable graphic features that make the NCB signatures unique.

Spatial awareness

Position, size and colour along with the spatial and proportional relationships of the NCB signature elements are predetermined and should not be altered. It should be noted that modification or re-treatment of the NCB symbol will detract from the integrity of the NCB signature and, more importantly, the value of the NCB brand. To ensure consistent representation of our brand identity always use high-quality vendors and reproduction methods.

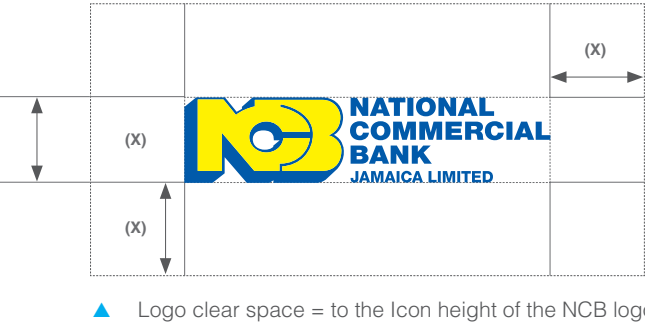
NOTE: The NCBFG signature and all its subsidiaries must appear on solid white background. In instances where multiple subsidiaries of the group are to be represented, the NCBFG logo should be used.

NCB logo clear space

As demonstrated below, the required clear space surrounding the mark is a function of the logo's equivalent height. It is important to maintain sufficient amount of space around the logo to ensure that the mark is distinct and easily identifiable at all times.

Clear spacing

A clear area around the NCB Signature will ensure maximum visibility and impact on social media asset. Avoid crowding the signature with other graphic elements such as typography, taglines and imagery. As indicated, the height of the NCB ICON (x) has been chosen as the standard unit of measurement for calculating the signature protection area.



Predetermined minimum size

To ensure that the NCB signatures are always legible and accurately reproduced, minimum size guidelines have been determined. Never reproduce the signature at sizes less than those shown. As illustrated, the minimum size is determined by measuring the height of the NCB custom-drawn logotype. However where space limitations dictate the use of a reproduction size that is smaller than the recommended minimum, contact us at brandncb@jncb.com for approval of those special applications. Observe the reproduction size requirements of the signature to avoid poor quality or distortion.



NOTE: The smallest approved signature in the Stacked logo format is 35 px.

NCB logo use case

Common errors to avoid



- A. DO NOT** change the typeface that National Commercial Bank Jamaica Limited is set in.
- B. DO NOT** use the NCB custom-drawn typeface that has the Black shadow.
- C. DO NOT** change the colour of any of the NCB Signature elements.
- D. DO NOT** change the relationship of any of the NCB logo elements.
- E. DO NOT** condense, stretch, rotate, flip, invert or distort any of the NCB logo elements.
- F. DO NOT** change a positive NCB logo into a reverse logo. Always use the positive versions for white or light colour backgrounds and reverse for Black or dark colour backgrounds.

Special Use Case Allowances



Positive monochrome version of the NCB Retail Banking logo. Allowed only in instances where use of color is limited by production.



Positive reverse of the NCB Signature logo. Allowed for use on dark colored backgrounds, patterns in instances where contrast between the signature logo colours and background cannot be achieved

NCB co-branding

In cases of external partnerships with organizations outside of NCBFG, it is imperative to adhere to the following guidelines.

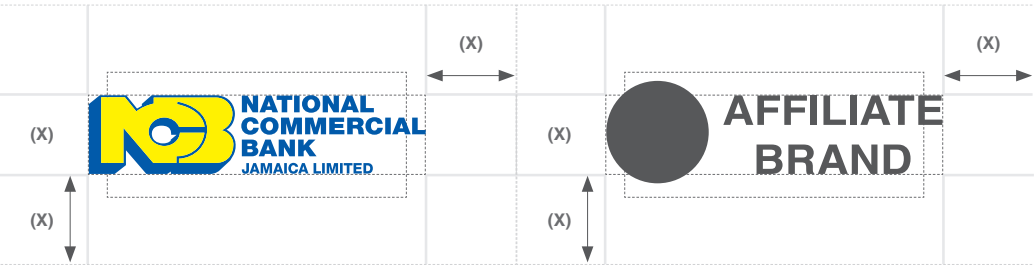
How to use the composite lockup

Any word/s or logo near the NCB Logotype indicating affiliation should be placed to the left of the logo in the safe area "x" .

In case of a specific need to combine the NCB logo with any other design, the following parameters should be met:

- ▶ Composite logos must be in a horizontal position and vertically middle-align for best balance.
- ▶ The composite logo should always use a divider line: 0.25 stroke with 20% black 100% of logo height.
- ▶ The distance between the NCB logo, the line and the design should follow the guidelines outlined.
- ▶ Don't lock logos without explicit permission from NCB.
- ▶ Don't add ampersands or underscores to logos

Horizontal affiliated partner composite lockup guide



Colour palette

Our color palette has been meticulously curated to consist of primary and neutral hues. While we acknowledge the inclination to imbue your personal touch, we kindly urge refraining from altering or introducing colors beyond the designated spectrum.

Primary colour

NCB Financial Group (NCBFG)

PMS	CYAN
CMYK	100/0/0/0
RGB	0/174/239
HEX	#00aeef

NCB Jamaica & NCB Foundation (NCBJ & NCBF)

PMS	287C
CMYK	100/70/0/0
RGB	0/91/170
HEX	#005baa

NCB Capital Markets (NCBCM)

PMS	021C
CMYK	0/50/100/0
RGB	247/148/29
HEX	#f7941d

NCB Insurance Agency & Fund Manager (NCBIAFM)

PMS	109 C
CMYK	0/10/100/0
RGB	251/221/0
HEX	#ffdd00

Black 90%

CMYK	0/0/0/90
RGB	0/0/0
HEX	#414042

Black 70%

CMYK	0/0/0/70
RGB	109/110/113
HEX	#6d6e71f

White

CMYK	100/100/100/100
RGB	255/255/255
HEX	#ffffff

Colour palette

Email background palette

The predefined background colours to use in our emails. You can mix and match these approved colours to create custom these to make your email for appealing. **Please note that the header colour is always #ffffff except for special use case. Special use case must be approved by one our Email Design Development Quality & Approval team.**

Icon palette

The predefined icon color for NCBFG, NCBJ, NCBF and NCBAIFM is **#00AEEF** and the predefined icon colour for NCBCM is **#F7941D**. Where applicable apply neutral colours. Refer to page 22 for neutral colours **For Dos and Don't related to the Icon design aesthetics refer to page 21.**

Call-out Point palette

The predefined Call-out Point color for NCBFG, NCBJ, NCBF and NCBAIFM is **#00AEEF** and **#005BAA**. The predefined icon colour for NCBCM is **#F7941D** and **#005BAA**. Where applicable the hero image can blend into the call out point.

For Dos and Don't refer to page 19.

Blue Level 1

RGB	242/250/255
HEX	#f2faff

Blue Level 2

RGB	226/242/252
HEX	#e2f2fc

Blue Level 3

RGB	0/174/239
HEX	#00aeef

Blue Level 4

RGB	0/91/170
HEX	#005baa

Blue Level 5

RGB	11/44/101
HEX	#0b2c65

Gray

RGB	238/238/238
HEX	#eeeeee

Typography and type hierarchy

Font Stack

The right font is essential to an effective email marketing campaign. Headings and paragraph text all make use of Helvetica (in alignment with the company's primary brand font). The fallback fonts are Arial and Sans-serif. We use this font stack because it offers an effective level of readability with a bit of brand reinforcement. Style declarations look like this for headings and paragraphs:

```
font-family: Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif;
```

Font family: Helvetica

Regular

AaBbCcDdEeFfGgHhIiJjKkLIMm
NnOoPpQqRrSsTtUuVvWwXxYyZz
1234567890 !@#\$%^&*()_+?

Bold

AaBbCcDdEeFfGgHhIiJjKkLIMm
NnOoPpQqRrSsTtUuVvWwXxYyZz
1234567890 !@#\$%^&*()_+?

A quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

Headline

Size: 32 px; **leading:** 36 px, **weight:** bold or regular, **text align:** center. The headline copy is set in sentence case using correct punctuation and proper nouns. Avoid using all caps. Use bold to draw urgent attention.

Sub-headline

Size: 24 px; **leading:** 29 px, **weight:** bold, **text align:** center. The sub headline copy is set in sentence case using correct punctuation and proper nouns. Avoid using all caps.

Introduction paragraph

Size: 20 px; **leading:** 24 px, **weight:** normal, **text align:** left or center. The body copy is set in sentence case using correct punctuation and proper nouns. Avoid using all caps.

Standard paragraph

Size: 15 px; **leading:** 18 px, **weight:** normal, **text align:** left or center. The body copy is set in sentence case using correct punctuation and proper nouns. Avoid using all caps.

Icon headline

Size: 24 px; **leading:** 29 px, **weight:** bold, **text align:** center. The icon headline copy is set in sentence case using correct punctuation and proper nouns. Avoid using all caps.

List headline

Size: 24 px; **leading:** 29 px, **weight:** bold, **text align:** center. The list headline copy is set in sentence case using correct punctuation and proper nouns. Avoid using all caps.

List sub-headline

Size: 18 px; **leading:** 22 px, **weight:** bold, **text align:** center. The list sub-headline copy is set in sentence case using correct punctuation and proper nouns. Avoid using all caps.

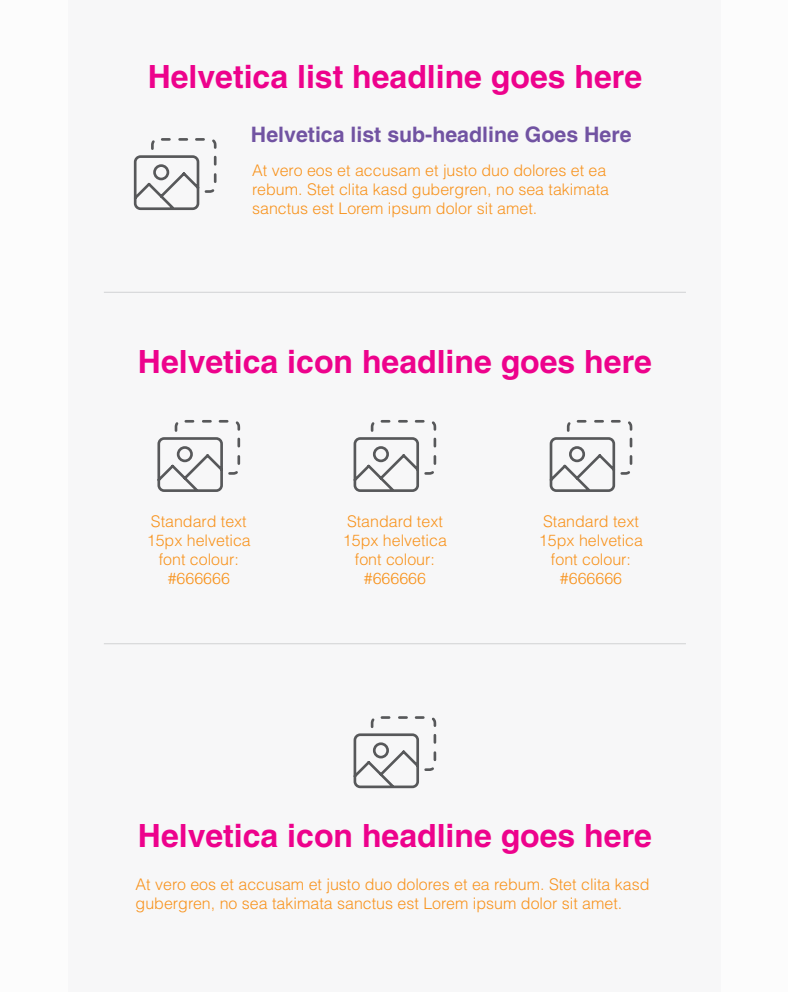
Footer text

Size: 12 px; **leading:** 14 px, **weight:** normal, **text align:** left. The footer text is set in sentence case using correct punctuation and proper nouns. Avoid using all caps.

Typography and type hierarchy



Typical type layout



Typical type layout

Typography don'ts

Just as the logo is an expression of the NCB Brand, Helvetica should be used in every application. Some common typography misuses are shown here when representing the brand in email.

Common errors to avoid

Put your best life forward

DO NOT apply gradient to any fonts. Font should always be one solid colour.

Put your best life forward

DO NOT add drop shadows to any copy.

Put your best life forward

DO NOT justify copy

Put your best life forward

DO NOT adjust the leading outside the prescribed settings refer to page 23.



Put your best life forward

DO NOT use italicised headlines.

Put your best life forward

DO NOT adjust the tracking outside the prescribed settings refer to page 23.

Put your best life forward

DO NOT use right alignment for headlines.

Put your best life forward

DO NOT use unapproved fonts.

Icon dos and don'ts

Simplicity and clarity

DO keep icons simple and easily recognizable at a glance.

Consistency, legibility and scalability

DO use the icon design should match the overall branding or application context. Use a consistent style, size, and colour scheme for all icons in a set. Make sure the icons are clear and easy to identify at different sizes, including small screens or large displays.

DO opt for vector-based formats to ensure scalability without loss of quality.

Use of color

DO use a limited colour palette to enhance visual appeal and convey meaning. Refer to page xx for colour guide

Alignment and grids

DO pay attention to the alignment of the elements and use grids to ensure consistent proportions and spacing.

Icon meaning and context:

DO ensure icons convey their intended meaning clearly and are easily understandable in the context they're used and conduct user testing to validate the icon's meaning and usability.

Common Errors To Avoid

DO NOT use inconsistent stroke width.

DO NOT use drop shadow on the icons

DO NOT use unapproved colours for the icons. Refer to page xx for approved colours.

DO NOT use hard edges

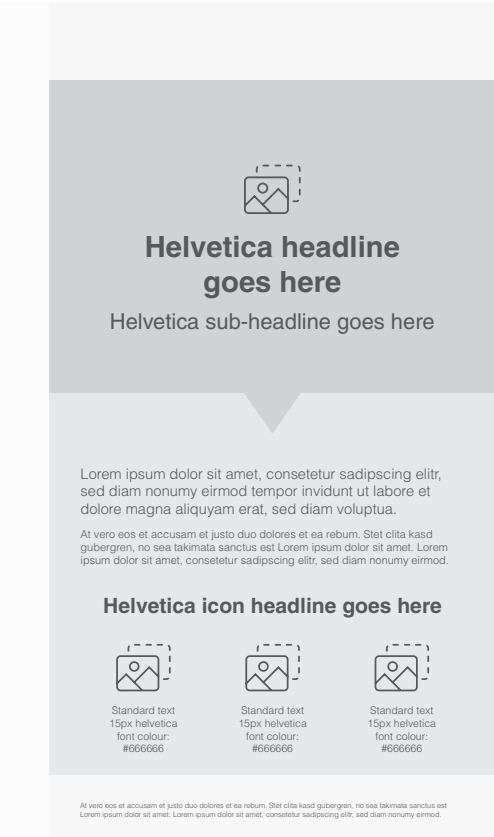
DO NOT use the icons on conflicting background.

DO NOT use pixelate or blur icons in your design.

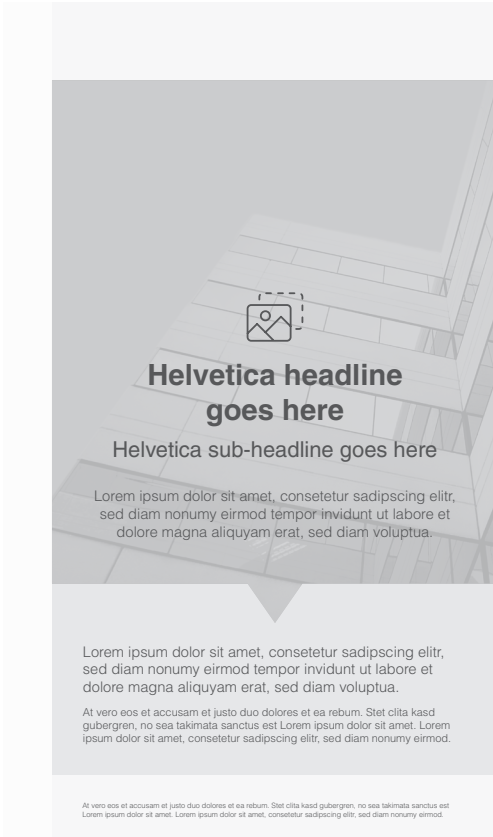


Call-Out Point

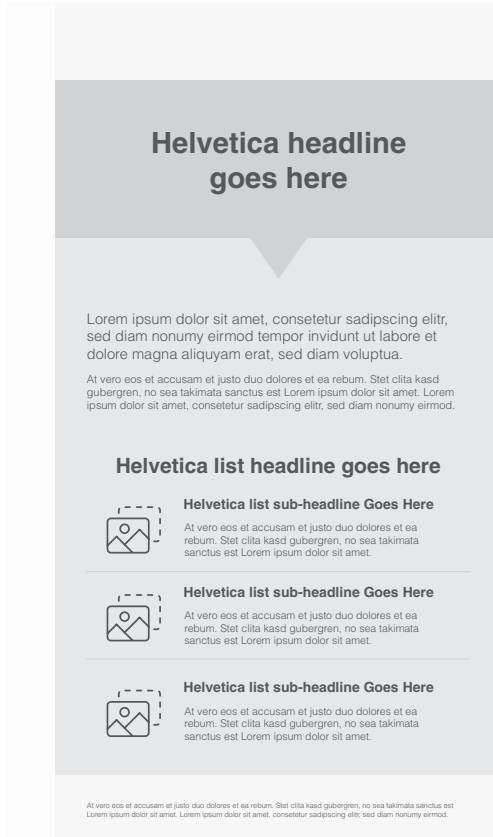
NCB's current advertising utilizes the design of “Call-Out Point” to place emphasis on significant areas of the layout including headlines, small body of text and images. This makes it easier to convey messages.



▲ Standard hero



▲ Expanded hero

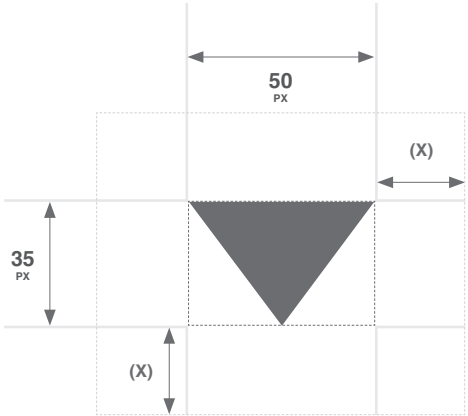


▲ Text hero

Call-Out Point don'ts

Clear space

The Call-Out Point remains an essential identifier of our brand and minimum size guidelines have been determined.



Y
Call-Out Point clear space

Common errors to avoid

- DO NOT rotate the Call-Out Point in the opposite -x, x and y direction.
- DO NOT condense, stretch, rotate, flip, invert or distort the x or y axes of Call-Out Point.
- DO NOT use drop shadow on the Call-Out Point.
- DO NOT repeat the use of the Call-Out Point in an email
- DO NOT chamfer or add rounded corners to the points of the Call-Out Point.
- DO NOT use the Call-Out Point on conflicting background.

► Email Testing

This section provides an overview of the pre-development and email testing stages, focusing on ensuring effectiveness, reliability, functionality and quality assurance.

What to explore in this section:

Pre-development and email test stage and quality assurance



Pre-development and email test stage

Testing and quality assurance are essential components of email development to ensure that your emails are error-free, display correctly and achieve their intended goals. Be guided by the following:

Pre-development checklist

Before you begin email development, create a pre-development checklist. This checklist should include the following items:

- ▶ Clear objectives for the email campaign.
- ▶ A comprehensive understanding of the target audience.
- ▶ Design mockups or wireframes.
- ▶ Defined brand guidelines.
- ▶ A list of email client compatibility requirements.



Cloud base tools to use

Litmus.com is an all-in-one platform for email marketing services that enables you to create, test, and send emails.

Putsmail.com/inliner: Enhance your design's compatibility and robustness by incorporating your styles directly using Putsmail.com/inliner. Inline CSS is a valuable method for constructing HTML emails, guaranteeing consistent rendering across a range of email clients.

Email Testing Stages



Render Testing: Test your email across the different email clients like Outlook, Gail and Apple Mail. Verify that your email renders properly and that images, text and styles are displayed as in intended.



Link and Image Testing: Ensure that images load correctly and contain appropriate alt text. Verify that all links are functional and confirm they direct users to their intended destinations.



Mobile Responsiveness: Put the email's responsiveness to the test on a range of mobile devices! Make sure it looks good and reads well on screens of all sizes.



Compatibility Testing: Examine rendering consistency across various web browsers and email clients, and resolve any disparities in email display.



Load Time Testing: Assess the email's load time and optimize images or code to reduce load times. Aim for fast loading to improve user experience.

Pre-development and email test stage



Proofreading and Content Validation: Thoroughly review all text, images, and content to eliminate typographical errors, grammatical issues, and inconsistencies.



Collaborative Review: Invite your team members to provide feedback and assist in the quality assurance process during the review and testing of the email to identify and address any overlooked issues.



User Acceptance Testing (UAT) Objectives: Define the objectives and criteria for user acceptance testing, involving stakeholders to validate that the email meets business objectives and branding guidelines.



Approval Process: Establish a formal approval process through our Email Design Development Quality & Approval team before sending the email to the intended recipients.